

LEARN, SPEAK, SHINE!



QUESTION OF THE DAY

- ✓ Every student answers one question.
- ✓ Builds confidence and gives equal chance to all.



SENTENCE FORMATION PRACTICE

- ✓ Create your own sentences.
- ✓ Improves grammar + vocabulary



SPEAKING ROUND

- ✓ Share your answers aloud.
- ✓ Boosts fluency & removes hesitation



FEEDBACK & CORRECTIONS

- ✓ Trainer guides on grammar & pronunciation.
- ✓ Encourages progress with positive motivation



English Proficiency Program

INTERACTIVE | PRACTICAL | CONFIDENCE-BUILDING

NOVEMBER 24

English Batch 02:30 PM

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Pendown: Keen Learner

Topic of the Day: Group Discussion

A group discussion is a conversation used to assess communication, knowledge, teamwork, and leadership skills by observing how individuals interact within a group on a given topic.

In GD small group of people talk about a given topic, problem, or situation within a limited time.

Difference Between GD and Debate

 GD is collaborative, while debate is competitive.

GD = Discussion

- ✓ Everyone works together, shares ideas, and builds a collective viewpoint.
- ✓ Aim is understanding, not winning

Debate = Argument

- ✓ Two sides argue against each other to prove which side is stronger.
- ✓ Aim is to prove your point

❖ **GD** **Do's** vs **Don'ts:**

DOs in a Group Discussion (GD)

1. Be Well-Prepared

- Know general topics, GD themes.

2. Understand the Topic & Speak Relevant

- Stick to the core idea.
- Avoid unnecessary diversion.

3. Pay Attention to Others

- Listen actively.
- Build on others' points.

4. Maintain Eye Contact

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- Look at all participants, not just one person.

5. Speak Clearly & Confidently

- Use simple language.
- Maintain a moderate pace (not too fast, not too slow).

6. Be Respectful & Polite

- Use courteous language.
- Show a cooperative attitude.

7. Be Factual & Give Real Examples

- Support points with data, facts, or short stories.

8. Encourage Others

- Give a chance to quieter participants.
- Promote team spirit.

9. Keep the Discussion on Track

- Bring the discussion back if it goes off-topic.

10. Summarize (If needed)

- Give a neutral conclusion without adding new points.

✗ DON'Ts in a Group Discussion (GD)

1. Don't Repeat or Rephrase the Same Point

- Add new insights instead of copying someone's idea.

2. Don't Dominate the Discussion

- Speak 2–4 meaningful times, but don't overtake the group.

3. Don't Interrupt or Cut Others

- Wait for a natural pause.

4. Don't Attack Anyone Personally

- Disagree with the point, not the person.

5. Don't Use Fillers

- Avoid "umm...", "hmm..."
- Take a short pause instead.

6. Don't Remain Silent Throughout

- You must contribute at least once.

7. Don't Speak Too Fast or Too Slow

- Maintain a moderate, easy-to-follow pace.

8. Don't Go Off-Topic

- Stay focused on the theme.

9. Don't Show Negative Body Language

- No folded arms, eye-rolling, or pointing fingers.

10. Don't Be Aggressive or Overconfident

- Assertive is good; arrogance is not.

Power Phrases for Group Discussions

Start-the-Discussion Lines

Purpose	Useful Sentence Starters
1. Invite someone to speak	• <i>What are your views about...</i> • <i>What do you think about...</i> • <i>We would love to hear your views about...</i> • <i>It would be interesting to hear ____'s views about...</i>
2. Clarify what was said	• <i>Could you give me your views in one sentence?</i> • <i>Is it your position that...</i> • <i>To be clear, you're saying that...</i> • <i>Can you please explain?</i> • <i>Can you please repeat what you said?</i>
3. Repeat / Reword what you heard	• <i>In other words, you're saying...</i> • <i>So, you're saying that...</i> • <i>I hear you saying that...</i>
4. Agree with the speaker	• <i>I agree with ____ because...</i> • <i>____'s point about ____ was important because...</i> • <i>There is evidence for what ____ is saying...</i> • <i>____ and I have the same views.</i> • <i>I concur with ____ about...</i>
5. Disagree with the speaker	• <i>I see it differently because...</i> • <i>I agree that ____, but we also have to consider that...</i>

Purpose	Useful Sentence Starters
	• <i>I do not think that...</i> • <i>I beg to differ because...</i> • <i>That's not always true. What about...</i>
6. Build on what someone said	• <i>___ mentioned that...</i> • <i>Absolutely, and furthermore...</i> • <i>___'s claim is interesting because...</i> • <i>Adding to what ___ said...</i>
7. Get your point in (politely)	• <i>Sorry to interrupt, but...</i> • <i>Can I say something here?</i> • <i>If I might add something here...</i>
8. Refocus the discussion on topic	• <i>Coming back to...</i> • <i>Let us not deviate from the topic...</i> • <i>We seem to have deviated from the topic...</i>
9. Summarize your views	• <i>Overall, I believe...</i> • <i>My whole point is...</i> • <i>To sum up, I think...</i>

Explanation

1. Invite someone to speak

 Use these sentences when someone is quiet or hasn't spoken yet.

This shows leadership and teamwork.

Example:

"What are your views about this?"

You encourage everyone to participate.

2. Clarify what was said

👉 Use these when you did not understand someone's point or need more detail.

It shows you are listening actively.

Example:

"To be clear, you're saying that social media causes distraction?"

3. Repeat / Reword what you heard

👉 Use these to confirm you understood the speaker correctly.

It avoids misunderstanding and shows good communication skills.

Example:

"So, you're saying that AI will impact jobs but also create new opportunities?"

4. Agree with the speaker

👉 Use these when you support someone's idea.

It builds harmony and moves the discussion forward.

Example:

"I agree with Aditi because she highlighted a very practical example."

5. Disagree with the speaker

👉 Use these when your opinion differs.

But you must disagree politely, without attacking the person.

Example:

"I see it differently because technology also creates many new job roles."

6. Build on what someone said

👉 Use these when you want to extend or add more information to someone's point.

It shows critical thinking and teamwork.

Example:

“Adding to what Rahul said, remote work has increased productivity for many companies.”

7. Get your point in politely

👉 Use these when the discussion is fast or people are cutting in.

You speak without sounding rude.

Example:

“Sorry to interrupt, but I’d like to add something here.”

8. Refocus the discussion

👉 Use these when the group starts going off-topic.

You help bring the conversation back to the main idea — a strong leadership skill.

Example:

“Let us not deviate from the topic; we were discussing online education, not technology in general.”

9. Summarize your views

👉 Use these when you want to conclude your point or wrap up the discussion.

Good for ending the GD or showing clarity.

Example:

“Overall, I believe that with proper regulation, AI can be beneficial to society.”

★ Simple Summary

Each sentence starter helps you do something important in a GD:

- Invite → bring others into conversation
- Clarify → understand properly
- Reword → confirm understanding
- Agree → support others
- Disagree → express different opinion politely

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- Build → add value to others' ideas
 - Get in → politely enter discussion
 - Refocus → bring back on topic
 - Summarize → conclude clearly